

Maxime Roche

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Professional Experience

Asian Development Bank – Manila, Philippines **Sep 2026 - present**
Economist, Agriculture & Nutrition (full-time) – Agriculture, Food, Nature, & Rural Development Sector (SD2)
Young Professional Programme

International Food Policy Research Institute – Washington DC, USA **Jan - May 2025**
Research Assistant (part-time, remote) – Foresight & Policy Modeling Unit

- Led a global systematic literature review of peer-reviewed studies estimating income and price elasticities of food demand, screening over 550 publications
- Performed a meta-analysis and estimated predicted meta-estimates by world region and food group
- Used estimated relationships to project global food demand through 2050 under climate scenarios
- Led the analysis and drafting of manuscript in collaboration with two co-authors (PI: Olivier Ecker)

Imperial College London – London, United Kingdom **Jun 2023 – Mar 2024**
Research Assistant (part-time) – Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation (CHEPI)

- Led the study design, data curation, analysis, and writing of a manuscript for the research project [“Modelling the Impact of a Tax on Foods high in fat, sodium, and sugar in India”](#) (PI: Franco Sassi)
- Coordinated a multidisciplinary team of 8 collaborators, including colleagues at CHEPI, the Indian Institute of Economic Growth, and Resolve to Save Lives; and led the publication in *PLOS Medicine*
- Presented research plans and results in stakeholders' engagement meetings at the Indian Institute of Economic Growth (Jun & Dec 2023) in New Delhi, India, including government officials

World Health Organization – Geneva, Switzerland **Apr 2022 – Jul 2023**
Consultant (part-time, remote) – Fiscal Policies for Health, Healthy Environments and Populations division

- Provided technical guidance and support in the conceptualization, survey design, global data collection, and analysis of alcohol and sugar-sweetened beverages prices and taxes
- Built databases and drafted [two WHO reports](#) and peer-reviewed articles for dissemination
- Led data collection for Latin American and Caribbean for WHO Report on the Global Tobacco Epidemic

Pan American Health Organization (WHO Regional Office) – Washington DC, USA **Mar 2019 – Mar 2022**
International Consultant (full-time) – Risk Factors & Nutrition Unit
Economics of Noncommunicable Diseases (NCDs) team

- Performed economic analyses of the return on investment of scaling up population level nutrition and health interventions to prevent noncommunicable diseases (Colombia, Peru, Suriname)
- Led survey instrument design, data collection, and analysis of prices and taxes on tobacco, alcohol, and sugar-sweetened beverage in Latin America and Caribbean, and built pioneer tax share indicators
- Designed capacity-building activities and participated in in-country missions and technical nutrition and health policy support to governments (El Salvador, Mexico, Paraguay)
- Managed inter-agency coordination (IDB, UNDP, World Bank) and regional governmental meetings
- Oversaw implementation of a budget of over USD 150,000 and mentored junior staff
- Synthesized evidence for policy briefs and guidelines, and led publication of multiple technical reports

World Bank – Washington DC, USA **Dec 2018 – Feb 2019**
Consultant (full-time) – Health, Nutrition & Population Global Practice
Health Equity and Financial Protection Indicators (HEFPI) dataset

- Participated in constructing a global dataset on health services utilization, health and nutritional outcomes, and financial protection against excess medical spending
- Coded 60+ surveys from developing countries: MICS, DHS, WHS (using STATA software)

KPMG – Paris, France **Sep 2015 – Feb 2016**
Junior Auditor (internship) – Department of Energy, Chemistry, and Pharmacy

- Carried out financial audit missions for CAC40 companies or subsidiaries of international groups
- Performed audit tests: treasury, fixed assets, stocks, equity, and accounts receivable/payable

Education

Imperial College London – London, UK **Sep 2022 – present**
PhD in Economics (expected graduation Summer 2026) – Department of Economics and Public Policy
Affiliated with the Center for Health Economics and Policy Innovation (CHEPI)
Thesis: “Essays in the Economics of Food & Nutrition” (defense date: September 2026)
Committee: Prof. Bhavani Shankar, Prof. Marisa Miraldo
Supervisors: Prof. Franco Sassi, Dr. Laure de Preux
Visiting researcher Spring 2025 to Dr. Ariel Ortiz-Bobea
Cornell University Dyson School of Applied Economics & Management - Ithaca, NY, USA

Imperial College London – London, UK **Sep 2021 – Aug 2022**
Master of Research in Economics – Department of Economics and Public Policy, GPA: 78%, Distinction

University of Amsterdam – Amsterdam, Netherlands **Sep 2017 – Jul 2018**
Master of Science in Economics (Public Policy track) – GPA: 8.3/10

EDHEC Business School – Nice, France **Sep 2014 – May 2017**
Double Degree MSc Corporate Finance and Banking / Master in Management – Programme Grande École
Academic exchange Spring 2016 at **Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez – Santiago, Chile**
MEPP – Magíster en Economía y Políticas Públicas (Master in Economics & Public Policy)

EDHEC Business School – Lille, France **Sep 2013 – May 2014**
Bachelor’s degree in Business Management – Programme Grande École

CPGE Lycée Joffre – Montpellier, France **Sep 2011 – Jun 2013**
Classe Préparatoire aux Grandes Écoles – Preparatory classes (120 ECTS – Equivalent of 2 years of Bachelor) in Mathematics and Physics for entrance in top French engineering and business schools

Teaching experience

Imperial College London – London, United Kingdom **Sep 2024 – Feb 2026**
Tutorial leader

- Microeconomics 2, BSc Economics, Finance, & Data Science (course lead: Prof. Tommaso Valletti) - 10-week course - 5h teaching/week (76 students) - student feedback [Fall 2024](#): 4.7/5, [Fall 2025](#): 4.6/5)
- Health Economics, MSc Global Health Management (course leader: Prof. Marisa Miraldo) - 5-week course - 2h teaching/week (105 students) - student feedback [Fall 2024](#): 4.8/5.

ONCAMPUS Global, University of Amsterdam – Amsterdam, Netherlands **Sep 2017 - Aug 2018**
Mathematics teacher, Pre-Bachelor program to enter the Bachelor of Science in Economics

- 22 international students (age 17-23) - year-long course - 12h/week - Calculus, Algebra II, Statistics

Languages and IT Skills

French (Native); English (Fluent); Spanish (Fluent)
Software skills Stata, Python, LaTeX, Microsoft Office (Advanced); VBA, Tableau (Working knowledge)

Grants and Awards

2021-2025	UK Economic and Social Research Council London Interdisciplinary Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership studentship Full-time tuition, monthly stipend, research & training funds (GBP 144,000)
2025	Turing Scheme UK Global Fellows Fund , overseas research funding (GBP 1,700)

Peer-reviewed publications

Roche M, Zhu J, Olney J, Laydon DJ, Joe W, Sharma M, Steele L, Sassi F. Taxation of foods high in fat, sugar, and sodium in India: A modelling study of health and economic impacts. *PLOS Medicine*. 2026 Jan 5; 23(1): e1004572. [doi: 10.1371/journal.pmed.1004572](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pmed.1004572)

Roche M. Can differentiated value-added tax rates promote healthier diets? The case of Costa Rica. *Food Policy*. 2025 Feb 1;131:102824. [doi: 10.1016/j.foodpol.2025.102824](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodpol.2025.102824)

Sandoval RC, Malik S, **Roche M**, Belausteguigoitia I, Morales-Zamora G. Lessons learned from fostering tobacco taxes in the Americas and implications for other health taxes. *Pan American Journal of Public Health*. 2023 May 19;46:e188. [doi: 10.26633/RPSP.2022.188](https://doi.org/10.26633/RPSP.2022.188)

Roche M, Sandoval RC, Monteiro MG. Comparing taxes on alcoholic beverages in the Region of the Americas. *Addiction*; 2023 Jan 29. [doi: 10.1111/add.16146](https://doi.org/10.1111/add.16146)

Roche M, Alvarado M, Sandoval RC, Gomes FS, Paraje G. Comparing taxes as a percentage of sugar-sweetened beverage prices in Latin America and the Caribbean. *The Lancet Regional Health-Americas*. 2022 Jul 1;11:100257. doi.org/10.1016/j.lana.2022.100257

Hutchinson B, Brispat F, Calderon L, [...] **Roche M**, Sandoval R. The case for investment in tobacco control: lessons from four countries in the Americas. *Pan American Journal of Public Health*. 2022 May 19;46:e174. [doi: 10.26633/RPSP.2022.174](https://doi.org/10.26633/RPSP.2022.174)

Sandoval RC, Gomes B, **Roche M**, Parra N, Armada F. Advances in tobacco control in the Region of the Americas, 2020. *Pan American Journal of Public Health*. 2021 Aug 12;45:e94-. [doi: 10.26633/RPSP.2022.202](https://doi.org/10.26633/RPSP.2022.202)

Sandoval RC, **Roche M**, Belausteguigoitia I, Alvarado M, Galicia L, Gomes FS, Paraje G. Excise taxes on sugar-sweetened beverages in Latin America and the Caribbean. *Pan American Journal of Public Health*. 2021 Apr 30;45:e21. [doi: 10.26633/RPSP.2021.21](https://doi.org/10.26633/RPSP.2021.21)

Working papers

Roche M, Comstock A, Ecker O. The Future of Food Demand: Global Meta-Analysis and Projections of Income and Price Elasticities. IFPRI Discussion Paper 2361. Sep 2025. [R&R at *Nature Food*] <https://hdl.handle.net/10568/176595>. Database: <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/OXZ0H6>

de Preux L, **Roche M**. How is climate fuelling the thirst for sweetness? Exploring drivers and adaptation. Exploring Drivers and Adaptation (May 08, 2024). Kilts Center at Chicago Booth Marketing Data Center Paper. 2024 May 8. [doi:10.2139/ssrn.4862789](https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4862789)

Book chapters

Thow AM, **Roche M**, Mandeville K, Hattersley L. Issues with respect to Taxation to Support Improved Nutrition. Chapter 13. United Nations. Handbook on Health Taxes for Developing Countries. Forthcoming 2026. [Link](#)

Sassi F, **Roche M**. Interaction between Health Taxes and other Instruments. Chapter 9. United Nations. Handbook on Health Taxes for Developing Countries. Forthcoming 2026. [Link](#)

Sandoval RC, **Roche M**, Perucic AM, Belausteguigoitia I, Alvarado M, Galicia L, Paraje G. Monitoring and measuring health taxes. Lauer J, Sassi F, Soucat A, Vigo A (Eds.), Health taxes: policy and practice. World Scientific, Singapore, for the World Health Organization, Geneva; 2023. Chapter 10. [doi:10.1142/9781800612396_0013](https://doi.org/10.1142/9781800612396_0013)

Commentaries

Roche M, Sassi F. The coming of age of food tax policy evaluations. *The Lancet Public Health*. 2026 Apr; 11(4):e203-e204. [doi: 10.1016/S2468-2667\(26\)00050-2](https://doi.org/10.1016/S2468-2667(26)00050-2)

Invited peer-reviewer

Journals Health Economics, Food Policy, Applied Economics, The Lancet Public Health, PLOS ONE, Climatic Change
Conferences European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE, 2025), European Association of Young Economists (EAYE, 2025), European Health Economic Association (EuHEA, 2024)

Academic conference & seminar presentations

2026 American Economic Association annual meeting (ASSA); University of York (*seminar*); Imperial College London's Public Health Policy Evaluation Unit (*seminar*)
2025 European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE); Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE); International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) (*seminar*); Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research (PIK)'s DENeB PhD Workshop 'Climate Change, Agriculture, and Health'; Columbia University's Interdisciplinary PhD Workshop in Sustainable Development; University of Costa Rica's School of Economics (*seminar*); Imperial College London's Economics & Public Policy (*seminar*)
2024 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA); European Health Economics Association (EuHEA); Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE); Canadian Economics Association; French Economists Association; University of Goettingen's Sustainable Food Systems Symposium; Maastricht University's Workshop on Applied Economics of the Environment; Imperial College London's Economics & Public Policy (*seminar*)
2023 IFPRI 'Delivering for Nutrition in South Asia' conference; University of Warwick 'Quantitative Methods in Social Sciences' workshop; University of Birmingham's Health Economics Unit (*seminar*); University of Costa Rica's School of Nutrition (*seminar*); Imperial College London's Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation (*seminar*); Imperial College London's Public Health Policy Evaluation Unit (*seminar*)

Selected institutional publications

Pan American Health Organization. Alcohol tax indicators in the Region of the Americas, 2024 ([link](#))
World Health Organization. Global report on the use of sugar-sweetened beverage taxes, 2023 ([link](#))
World Health Organization. Global report on the use of alcohol taxes, 2023 ([link](#))
Pan American Health Organization. Healthy Americas' Coalition, and ICESI University. Fiscal policies and noncommunicable diseases (in Spanish), 2023, ([link](#))
Pan American Health Organization. Prevention and control of noncommunicable diseases and mental health conditions in Peru: The case for investment (in Spanish), 2022 ([link](#))
Pan American Health Organization. The case for investment in tobacco control: lessons from four countries in the Americas, 2022 ([link](#))
Pan American Health Organization. Sugar-sweetened beverage taxation in the Region of the Americas, 2021 ([link](#))

Selected policy presentations

UK Department of Health and Social Care & World Health Organization, Regional Office for Europe. Sugar and Calorie Reduction Network meeting. Fiscal Leavers. *The Costa Rica value-added tax* (London, UK, 2025, [link](#))
Pan American Health Organization. How can we monitor tax policies in alcohol and sugar-sweetened beverages? *Health tax policies in Latin America and the Caribbean: Are we making progress?* (virtual presentation, 2022, [link](#))
European Commission and ICF. Lessons learned from Chile and other Latin American and Caribbean countries on HFSS food and beverage taxes. *Mapping of fiscal measures and pricing policies applied to food, non-alcoholic and alcoholic beverages* (virtual presentation, 2022, [link](#))
Vital Strategies, Pan American Health Organization, and ACT Brazil. Health taxes save lives, reduce health expenditures, and increase revenue. A special focus on alcohol taxes in the Region of the Americas. *Fiscal and other regulations of alcohol in Brazil* (virtual presentation, 2021, [link](#))
Pan American Health Organization and Tobacconomics. Tobacco taxes in Latin America (in Spanish). *Presentation of Tobacconomics' Cigarette Tax Scorecard* (virtual presentation, 2021, [link](#))
Congress of Paraguay. Noncommunicable diseases: Scientific evidence for the use of fiscal policies for health (In Spanish) (Asuncion, Paraguay, 2019, [link](#))

Miscellaneous

Memberships	American Economic Association (AEA), European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE), Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE), United Nations Subcommittee on Health Taxes
Courses	University of Copenhagen's Department of Food and Resource Economics 'International PhD course: Food and health policy analysis using home-scan data' (Denmark, Dec 2023) BREAD-IGC 'Virtual PhD course on Environmental Economics' (virtual, 2023)
Other	United Nations' Subcommittee on Health Taxes meeting (Geneva, 2025) Global Fellows Programme: 'Data for sustainability' (NTU Singapore, 2023)

Academic and professional references

Prof Franco Sassi, Chair International Health Policy & Economics, Imperial College London -

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Dr Laure de Preux, Associate Professor of Economics, Imperial College London - l.depreux@imperial.ac.uk

Dr Olivier Ecker, Senior Research Fellow, International Food Policy Research Institute - o.ecker@cgiar.org

Ms Rosa Sandoval, Regional Advisor Tobacco Control, Pan American Health Organization - sandovar@paho.org

Ms Anne-Marie Perucic, Fiscal Policies for Health, World Health Organization, perucica@who.int